

Will AI Help or Hurt Work and the Economy? What People Around the World Expect

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One Sentence Summary: Workers globally expect AI to facilitate more than threaten jobs, especially in less productive economies.

Abstract

Artificial intelligence may augment workers, displace labor, or do both. We elicit beliefs from more than 64,000 adults across 32 countries, covering 65% of the world’s population and 85% of global output. Workers are substantially more likely to expect artificial intelligence to facilitate than threaten their jobs. Facilitation is more prevalent in lower-productivity countries, whereas threat is unrelated to productivity. Facilitation and threat often coexist within individuals, indicating that perceived benefits and risks are distinct rather than opposite dimensions. They are also associated with different macroeconomic expectations: facilitation with stronger expected growth and employment, and threat with weaker employment and higher inflation. These heterogeneous beliefs may shape the diffusion and acceptance of artificial intelligence across countries.

1 Introduction

AI can augment workers and automate tasks, raising productivity, but it can also reduce the demand for labor in the skills it substitutes. Existing research points to potentially large but heterogeneous effects on productivity and employment (1, 2, 3). Their aggregate magnitude and incidence remain highly uncertain and difficult to predict, even among experts (4).

We thank Paul Menge for excellent research assistance. The survey was an independently designed and funded academic research project conducted by the European Expectations Center at ESMT Berlin and the Bank for International Settlements. Cint served exclusively as the survey-fielding provider, recruiting respondents and collecting responses, and had no role in the research design, financing, analysis, interpretation, or reporting of the results.

Before these effects become visible in measured productivity, employment, or wages, workers form beliefs about how AI will affect their own jobs and the broader economy. These beliefs may shape AI adoption and acceptance and influence expectations about AI’s effect on economic growth, employment, and inflation. This matters because subjective expectations affect economically relevant choices and, through those choices, aggregate outcomes (5, 6). Expected benefits and risks from AI need not be mutually exclusive. People may expect AI to facilitate existing tasks while also viewing it as a threat to their job. Distinguishing these dimensions is important because productivity gains and labor displacement do not need to move one-for-one (7, 8).

However, systematic evidence on how people expect AI to affect their jobs and the economy remains limited. Existing studies focus on the United States or a small set of advanced economies (9, 10, 11, 12). To our knowledge, no independently funded academic research or peer-reviewed contributions study and link these two dimensions globally. Cross-country commercial or industry-partnered reports document international variation in attitudes toward AI, but without jointly measuring AI beliefs and aggregate economic expectations (13, 14). This gap is important because subjective economic expectations differ substantially across and within countries and drive all economically relevant choices households make, above and beyond the direct effects of AI (15, 16).

We address this gap using an independently funded global survey of more than 64,000 adults across 32 countries, fielded in April and May 2026. The survey provides harmonized measures of AI expectations across economies that differ in productivity, sectoral composition, labor-market institutions, income, and technological capacity. These differences are particularly relevant for AI, whose adoption remains highly uneven across countries (17). The global setting therefore allows us to study whether people facing different institutional, economic, and technological environments form systematically different AI expectations.

We use the survey to measure several dimensions of AI expectations. Among employed respondents (*workers*), we separately elicit agreement with the statements that AI will “facilitate my work” and “threaten my work.” All respondents also report whether they expect AI to increase or decrease economic growth, employment, and inflation in their country. In addition, we observe 12-month-ahead expectations for household income, unemployment, and inflation that were elicited before the AI module in the survey, allowing us to distinguish beliefs about AI-specific effects from broader economic outlooks. The survey also records a rich set of demographic and socioeconomic characteristics.

Our analysis proceeds in three steps. We first characterize cross-country and within-country variation in expected AI facilitation and threat, with particular attention to their relationship with countries’ productivity. We then examine whether these expectations coexist within individuals and how they relate to expected effects on economic growth, employment, and inflation. Finally, we assess which individual characteristics help us understand the global cross-sectional variation in AI beliefs.

2 Data and Setting

The data come from a special module on the economic effects of AI included in the 2026 wave of the *Global Subjective Expectations Survey* (GSES), conducted jointly by the European Expectations Center (EEC) at ESMT Berlin and the Bank for International Settlements (BIS). The Supplementary Materials provide details on the survey design, implementation, and construction of the variables used in the analysis (Section A).

The survey was fielded in April and May 2026 in 32 countries and includes more than 64,000 adult respondents that cover around 65% of the global population and more than 85% of worldwide GDP. Country samples were recruited through Cint’s global network of online survey panels. Cint fielded the survey and the samples were designed to be broadly representative of the local adult population between the ages of 18 and 70 by age and gender, following the harmonized sampling approach used in earlier waves of the GSES (18, 16). Respondents were screened for age and attention. The questionnaire was translated into each country’s official languages using a common translation protocol. Because our main outcomes concern beliefs about respondents’ own existing jobs, the analysis of perceived facilitation and threat is restricted to employed respondents.

Our main variables of interest capture expectations about AI’s effects on respondents’ own jobs and on the aggregate economy. Employed respondents separately report how strongly they agree with the statements “AI will facilitate my work” and “AI will threaten my work” on five-point scales ranging from “not agree at all” to “fully agree.” We recenter both measures to range from -1 to $+1$ in the multivariate analysis.¹ Respondents also report whether they expect AI to increase or decrease economic growth, employment, and inflation in their country, using five-point scales centered at “no impact.” These questions do not specify a forecast horizon. Finally, before the AI module, the survey elicits quantitative 12-month expectations for household income growth, unemployment, and inflation, which we use to measure respondents’ broader economic outlooks above and beyond the effects of AI.²

3 Results

3.1 Global Facts about Expected Labor Benefits and Risks from AI

Figure 1 summarizes cross-country variation in workers’ expectations about the effects of AI on their own jobs. For each country, the figure reports the share of employed respondents who agree that AI will either “facilitate my work” (Panel A) or “threaten my work” (Panel B). Darker shading indicates a larger share of respondents agreeing with the respective statement; countries not covered by the GSES are shown in gray. Two features stand out.

First, workers are, on average, substantially more likely to expect AI to facilitate than to threaten their current jobs. This result contrasts with prominent U.S. evidence emphasizing concerns about

¹We use qualitative Likert scales to reduce cognitive burden and facilitate comparability across countries and institutional settings (19).

²Section A of the Supplementary Materials provides details on survey implementation, variable construction, and construction of the analysis sample. Tables S2–S4 report summary statistics and background characteristics, and Tables S5–S12 compare the survey samples with official country-level benchmarks.

job displacement (9), but is consistent with the limited labor-market effects observed so far: despite rapid AI adoption, existing studies document productivity gains and substantial task reorganization, but little evidence of broad declines in employment outcomes or earnings (20, 21). At the same time, recent evidence points to weaker employment outcomes for younger workers in occupations most exposed to AI, primarily through reduced hiring rather than widespread displacement of existing workers (22).³

Second, both perceived facilitation and perceived threat vary substantially across countries. The share of employed respondents who expect AI to facilitate their work ranges from 42% to 86% across the countries in our sample. Perceived threat also varies, although over a narrower and lower range, from 18% to 46%. The large dispersion in both dimensions indicates that workers’ expectations about AI differ substantially across institutional settings and economies.

The cross-country variation is not confined to differences between advanced and emerging economies. For instance, beliefs about the benefits of AI are especially high in most countries in our sample that belong to or are invited to join the BRICS intergovernmental group.⁴ At the same time, substantial heterogeneity is evident within closely integrated regions. Among European countries, for example, more than three quarters of workers in Switzerland expect AI to facilitate their work, compared with less than 45% in Italy and Poland.

Expected threat shows a different cross-country pattern. Countries with similarly high expectations of facilitation often differ quite substantially in expected job risk. Among the large emerging economies in our sample, expected threat is relatively high in India and South Africa but relatively low in China, Russia, and Brazil. Substantial variation is also present within Europe, indicating that expectations about facilitation and threat capture distinct dimensions of how people assess the effects of AI.

A particularly salient contrast emerges between China and the United States, the two leading countries in AI research and model development as of 2026 (23). Workers in China report substantially greater expected facilitation from AI and, at the same time, lower perceived threat than workers in the United States.

3.2 Perceived AI Benefits Decline with a Country’s Productivity

The pronounced cross-country differences in perceived facilitation and threat raise the question of whether they are systematically related to countries’ characteristics. We focus on country-level productivity, which varies substantially across our sample and provides a natural measure of countries’ distance from the technological frontier.

Productivity could relate to AI benefits in either direction. On the one hand, workers in economies farther from the productivity frontier may see greater scope for AI to improve existing work practices, consistent with evidence that AI can generate greater gains for less experienced or lower-performing workers (2). On the other hand, AI may be more valuable in more productive

³Our survey focuses on employed respondents and asks about the effects of AI on their current jobs. It therefore does not capture expectations about hiring or labor-market entry.

⁴Based on membership as of September 1, 2026, the BRICS countries in our sample are: Brazil, China, India, Indonesia, Russia, Saudi Arabia (invited country at the time of our survey), and South Africa.

economies, where workers have the skills and firms the organizational capacity, financing, and infrastructure needed to deploy AI effectively (24, 3).

To assess the sign of this relationship empirically, we merge the survey data with country-level total factor productivity (TFP) from the Penn World Table (25). Figure 2 plots mean perceived facilitation against 2023 TFP at current purchasing-power parities (PPP), normalized to one for the United States. We find that the relationship is strongly negative: workers in less productive economies report substantially greater expected facilitation from AI. This gradient remains economically and statistically significant in individual-level regressions controlling for income, education, sector of employment, and other respondent characteristics (Table S13 column (1) in the Supplementary Materials), which may correlate with TFP.

At the same time, the negative association between beliefs about AI benefits and country-level productivity is concentrated at lower levels of productivity and flattens toward the upper end of the distribution. In Fig. 2, we color code two groups of countries: Advanced Economies (AEs, dark blue) and Emerging Market Economies (EMEs, dark red), because one might expect that a country’s TFP correlates largely with the country’s position relative to the technological frontier. Indeed, countries with lower TFP are more likely to be EMEs.⁵ Interestingly, the color coding reveals that the relationship between expected AI facilitation and TFP is steeper in the lower part of the TFP distribution than in the upper part. Indeed, while workers in countries with very low TFP, such as India, Indonesia, and China, have very optimistic expectations about AI’s ability to facilitate their jobs relative to other EMEs with higher TFP, such as Mexico and Argentina, the gradient is flatter for AEs: the average beliefs are similar for workers in Japan, whose TFP is about 0.7, as well as workers in Germany, whose TFP is around 1.

We find that a similar productivity gradient does not arise for expected threat (see Figure S2 in the Supplementary Materials and column (2) of Table S13). This non-result indicates that expected AI benefits and risks are not simply opposite manifestations of a common assessment of AI. Cross-country differences in employment protection do not account for this pattern: perceived threat is also unrelated to the World Bank Redundancy Rules Index (26), our proxy for regulatory and institutional constraints on layoffs (Table S14 in the Supplementary Materials).

The distinction between facilitation and threat also appears at the individual level. Workers who expect greater scope for AI to assist their work may nevertheless feel more exposed to automation, so the two beliefs need not move in opposite directions. We find that workers who expect AI to facilitate their work are, on average, less likely to perceive it as a threat (see Fig. S1 in the Supplementary Materials). This negative association remains after controlling for demographic and other individual characteristics. One interpretation is that workers who perceive greater scope for AI to complement their tasks also view it as less likely to substitute for their labor. Other mechanisms are possible, however, including differences in access to AI, exposure to automation, or general attitudes toward the technology. Our data do not distinguish among these explanations. Despite this average correlation, the negative association is not uniform across the distribution. Among respondents who expect little facilitation and little threat, the two beliefs are positively related.

⁵Turkey has high measured TFP at current purchasing-power parities, possibly due to its weak currency and high inflation levels at the time of measurement in 2023.

This pattern is consistent with a group of workers who view AI as largely irrelevant to their current jobs, expecting neither substantial benefits nor substantial risks. We treat this interpretation as suggestive, as the survey does not directly measure perceived relevance of AI to respondents’ tasks.

We can then characterize the joint distribution of AI beliefs more directly. We classify workers according to whether they agree that AI will facilitate their work, threaten their work, both, or neither. Nearly half (47.8%) expect facilitation without threat, 11.2% report threat without facilitation, 18.8% report both, and 22.3% report neither (Fig. S3 in the Supplementary Materials). Thus, perceived benefits and risks often coexist rather than offsetting one another. This joint structure motivates our next question: whether different combinations of job-level beliefs are associated with different expectations about AI’s effects on the broader economy.

3.3 Job-level AI Beliefs and Expectations About the Economy

Workers’ beliefs about AI’s effects on their own jobs are systematically associated with how they expect AI to affect the broader economy. We estimate within-country regressions of expected AI effects on economic growth, employment, and inflation on perceived facilitation and threat, controlling for general demographic characteristics, employment type, sector, and beliefs about AI’s capabilities relative to human intelligence. Panel A of Table 1 reports the estimates.

Workers who expect AI to facilitate their work also expect stronger effects of AI on economic growth and employment and lower inflation. Expected threat is associated with the opposite pattern: weaker expected effects on growth and employment and higher inflation. The associations are asymmetric across outcomes. Facilitation is more strongly related to expected growth and employment, whereas threat is more strongly related to expected inflation.

These associations are consistent with a supply-side interpretation of AI adoption, in which productivity improvements raise output and employment while reducing inflation. More broadly, they echo recent evidence that households often organize macroeconomic beliefs around supply-side narratives, associating stronger economic activity with lower inflation and weaker activity with higher inflation (27, 28, 29, 30).

To examine how facilitation and threat interact, we consider the classification of workers into four groups according to whether they expect AI to facilitate their work, threaten their work, both, or neither. Using workers who report neither as the reference group, facilitation-only workers expect stronger effects of AI on growth and employment and lower inflation, whereas threat-only workers expect weaker growth and employment effects and higher inflation. Workers who report both facilitation and threat resemble the facilitation-only group in their expectations for growth and employment, but anticipate the largest increase in inflation (Panel B of Table 1).

These results further stress that expected threat of AI does not simply offset expected facilitation. Workers who expect both continue to anticipate relatively favorable AI effects on the economy, while at the same time expecting stronger inflationary effects than any other group.

The cross-country productivity gradient in expected facilitation also extends to expected aggregate growth. Workers in less productive economies anticipate larger positive effects of AI on economic growth: country-level TFP is negatively associated with expected AI-induced growth, but not systematically related to expected employment or inflation effects (Fig. S4 in the Supplementary

Materials).

Taken together, these patterns are consistent with a perceived catch-up opportunity: workers in less productive economies see greater scope for AI to improve their own work and to raise aggregate output. Importantly, these responses concern the expected effects of AI itself, rather than unconditional expectations about future economic growth. The productivity gradient therefore reflects differences in perceived gains from AI, not simply greater expected convergence among lower-productivity economies.

3.4 Job-level AI Beliefs and Near-Term Economic Outlooks

The previous analysis links workers’ beliefs about AI’s effects on their own jobs to their expectations about AI’s effects on the economy. We next ask whether these job-level beliefs also matter for general near-term economic outlooks rather than specifically the effects of AI on the economy. The survey elicits 12-month-ahead expectations for household income, unemployment, and inflation.

A useful feature of the survey structure is that these broader economic expectations are elicited before respondents encounter the AI module. By contrast, beliefs about AI’s effects on respondents’ own jobs are elicited immediately before beliefs about AI’s aggregate effects. The earlier placement of the 12-month expectations thus reduces concerns that their association with job-level AI beliefs is mechanically induced by question order or a desire for internal consistency in responses.

Workers who expect AI to facilitate their work also expect stronger growth in their household income over the next year. Their unemployment expectations and their near-term quantitative inflation expectations do not differ significantly. Expected threat is associated with a more pessimistic outlook: workers who feel more threatened by AI expect higher unemployment and higher inflation, but, interestingly, do not report significantly different household-income growth over the next 12 months (Table 2).

These associations show that job-level AI beliefs are related to broader economic expectations beyond respondents’ beliefs about the specific effects of AI on the economy. Expected facilitation is most closely associated with stronger expected household-income growth, whereas expected threat is associated with higher expected unemployment and inflation.

3.5 Individual Correlates of Perceived AI Facilitation and Threat

The preceding results reveal substantial heterogeneity in expected AI facilitation and threat across and within countries. We next examine which, if any, individual characteristics are systematically associated with AI beliefs using the rich set of demographic, socioeconomic, preference, and employment characteristics we observe. Because the analysis is observational, these relationships must be interpreted as correlations rather than causal determinants.⁶

Figure 3 reports coefficient estimates and 95% confidence intervals from separate regressions of expected AI facilitation and threat on the full set of observed individual characteristics. All covariates enter jointly, so the estimates capture conditional associations holding the remaining

⁶The global cross-sectional design does not allow causal identification of the sources of these beliefs through randomized variation or natural experiments (31, 32, 33, 34).

characteristics constant.⁷ To avoid that systematic differences in the characteristics of populations across countries drive any correlations, the specification includes a full set of country fixed effects.

Income exhibits the clearest divergence between the two dimensions. Within countries, higher-income workers are substantially more likely to expect AI to facilitate their work and less likely to expect it as a threat. Education shows a different pattern: more educated workers report greater expected facilitation but also slightly greater expected threat. Perceived facilitation is concave in age, that is, initially increasing but then decreasing; the corresponding age profile for perceived threat is not statistically significant.

Gender differences are comparatively small. Despite well-documented gender gaps in labor-market outcomes and economic expectations (35, 36, 37, 38, 15), women do not differ significantly from men in expected facilitation and report only a modestly higher level of expected threat.

Trust is also systematically related to AI beliefs (39, 15). Workers reporting greater trust in their country’s government are more likely to expect AI to facilitate their work and less likely to threaten it, but the latter association is not significant. Economic preferences and financial literacy show distinct patterns: more risk-tolerant respondents expect both greater facilitation and greater threat, whereas more impatient respondents expect substantially greater threat. Higher numeracy is associated with greater expected facilitation, while greater inflation literacy is associated with lower expected threat but also lower expected facilitation (40, 19).

Beliefs about AI’s future capabilities are strongly associated with expected facilitation, but surprisingly not with expected threat. Workers who expect AI to compare more favorably with human intelligence over the next decade are substantially more likely to expect it to facilitate their work, yet no more likely to view it as a threat to their job. This asymmetry suggests that perceived technological capability is not interpreted simply as a proxy for labor substitution.

Sectoral patterns provide further evidence that facilitation and threat capture distinct dimensions of perceived exposure. Relative to manufacturing (omitted category in regression), workers in healthcare and hospitality report both lower expected facilitation and lower perceived threat, consistent with the greater importance of in-person and interpersonal skills in these sectors. Workers in transportation and in arts, media, and entertainment report lower expected facilitation without a corresponding reduction in expected threat.

Knowledge-intensive sectors display a different pattern. Workers in information and communication technology (ICT), where exposure to workplace AI is likely to be relatively high, report greater perceived facilitation without a corresponding increase in threat. By contrast, workers in finance and insurance report substantially greater perceived threat and only a marginally greater facilitation. The latter pattern is consistent with recent U.S. evidence showing substantial expected AI threat in the financial sector (41).

Taken together, these sectoral patterns reinforce the distinction between expected AI facilitation and threat. The two dimensions do not move one-for-one across sectors, indicating that workers in different parts of the economy combine expected benefits and risks from AI in systematically different ways.

⁷The corresponding coefficient estimates and standard errors are reported in Table S15 of the Supplementary Materials.

4 Discussion

The results reveal substantial heterogeneity in how workers expect AI to affect their jobs and the broader economy. Across countries, expected facilitation is substantially more common than expected threat, yet the two frequently coexist. Most notably, workers in less productive economies perceive greater scope for AI to facilitate their work and to raise aggregate growth, whereas perceived threat shows no systematic relationship with national productivity. These patterns indicate that workers distinguish between the potential benefits and risks of AI rather than viewing them as opposite ends of a single dimension.

The distinction between facilitation and threat also has policy relevance. Workers may expect substantial productivity gains from AI while remaining concerned about displacement, so low expected threat does not necessarily imply high expected benefits. These beliefs are also related to institutional attitudes: within countries, workers who report greater trust in their country’s government expect more facilitation. Although these associations are descriptive, they suggest that policies supporting AI adoption may need to address two distinct margins: enabling workers and firms to realize productivity gains while facilitating adjustment for workers who expect meaningful risks to their jobs.

More broadly, the results show why expectations about emerging technologies can matter before their long-run effects are visible in aggregate data. Expected AI threat is associated with higher expected unemployment, while expected facilitation with stronger expected household-income growth. We do not observe whether these beliefs causally affect consumption, saving, job search, or skill acquisition in our setting, although earlier research has documented that expectations do affect all these choices (5, 6) in a causal fashion. The results thus are consistent with a potential expectations channel through which technological change may influence behavior before its aggregate effects are fully realized, which in turn might endogenously affect AI adoption and acceptance and hence economic outcomes.

A few limitations qualify the interpretation of these results. The survey does not provide respondents with a standardized definition of AI, so responses reflect the technologies that individuals themselves associate with the term. This may introduce cross-country and individual variation in the object being evaluated, but it also captures beliefs about AI as workers currently understand and encounter it. Moreover, we do not observe directly realized adoption, productivity gains, displacement, or respondents’ exposure to AI.

Taken together, the evidence suggests that workers do not hold a single positive or negative view of AI. They distinguish between its potential to facilitate their own work, its potential to threaten their jobs, and its broader effects on growth, employment, and inflation. Understanding these distinct beliefs is important because the economic consequences of AI will depend not only on what the technology ultimately does, but also on its acceptance and adoption, which in turn depends on how workers expect to be affected. The results document substantial variation in AI beliefs across countries, which might lead to differential adoption and diffusion patterns, and hence aggregate effects, around the world.

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C.B., F.D., F.D.F., D.S. and M.W. designed research, performed research, analyzed data, and wrote the paper.

Competing interests:

Authors declare no competing interests.

Data and materials availability:

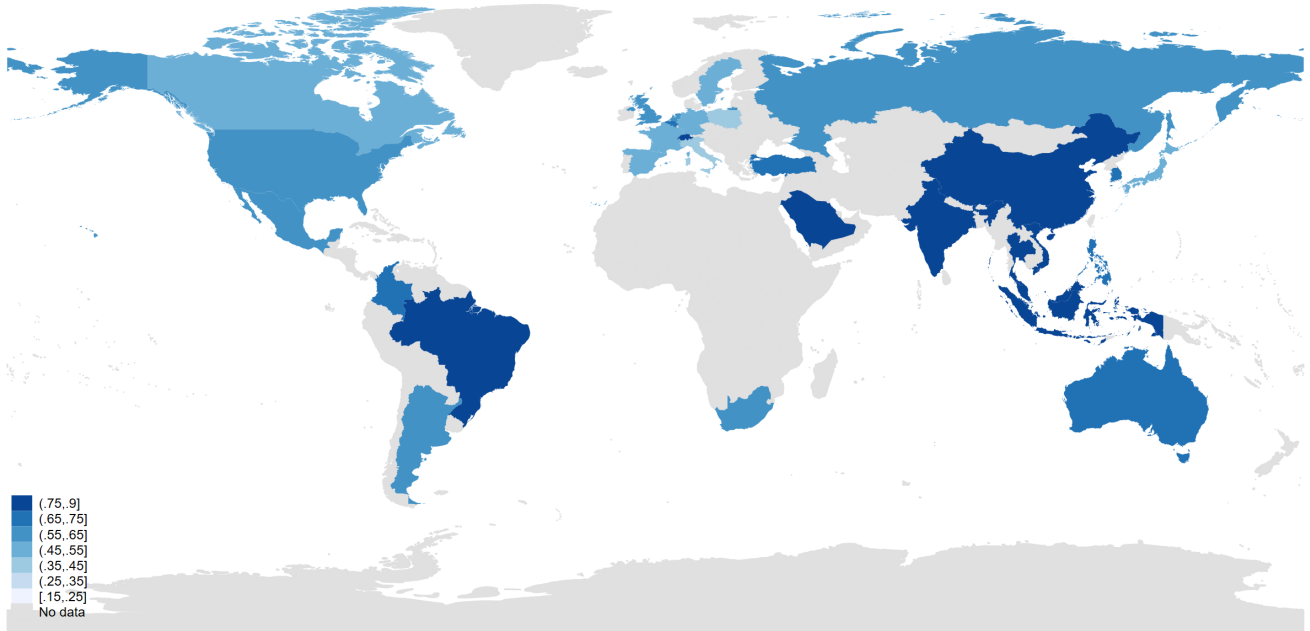
The data and analysis files are available under DOI: 10.4231/58Y0-HZ73

Supplementary Information

The following supplementary information is available for this article: Figs. S1 to S4
Tables S1 to S15

Figures and Tables

Panel A. Variation in “AI will facilitate my work”



Panel B. Variation in “AI will threaten my work”

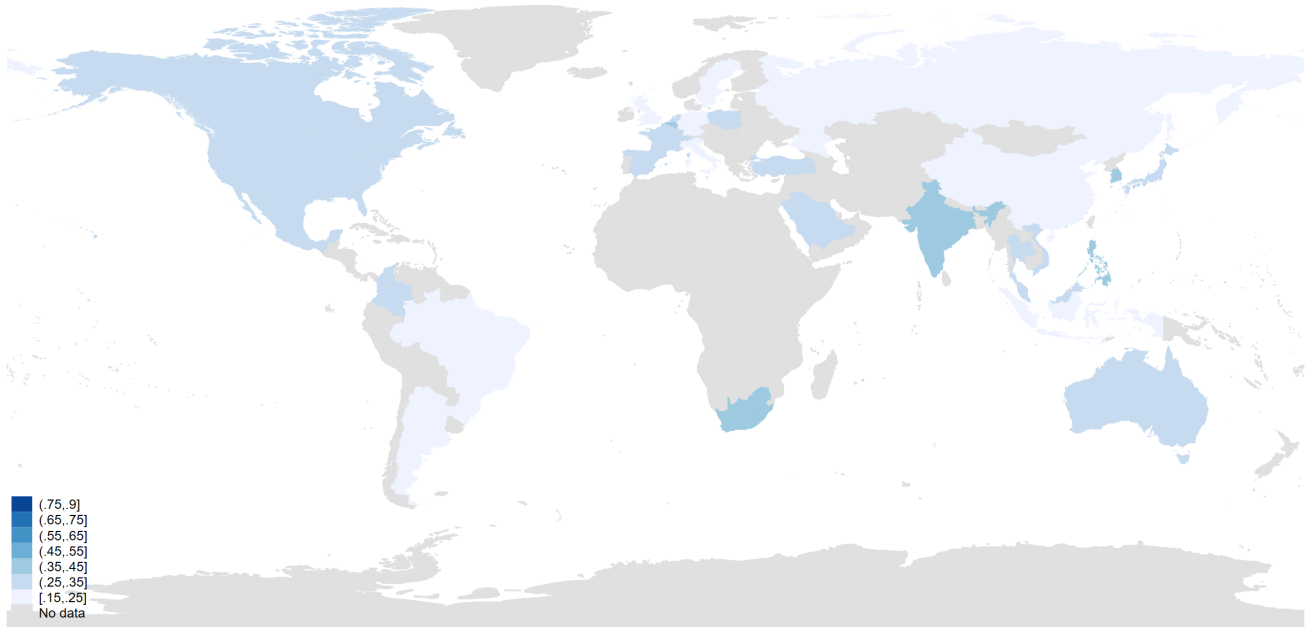


Figure 1: **Global variation in expected job-level effects of AI.** Country-level shares of employed respondents who agree that AI will facilitate their work (A) or threaten their work (B). Darker shading indicates a larger share of respondents agreeing with the respective statement; countries not covered by the survey are shown in gray.

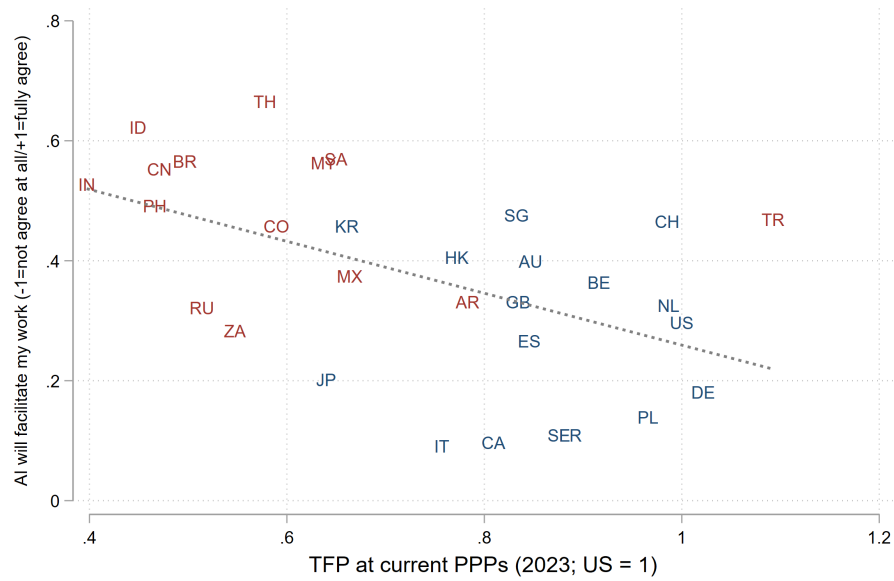


Figure 2: **Perceived AI facilitation declines with country-level productivity.** Country-level mean perceived facilitation is plotted against total factor productivity in 2023 at current purchasing-power parities, normalized to one for the United States. Each marker represents one country. Advanced economies are shown in blue and emerging-market economies in red. The fitted line summarizes the cross-country relationship. Vietnam is excluded because comparable TFP data are unavailable.

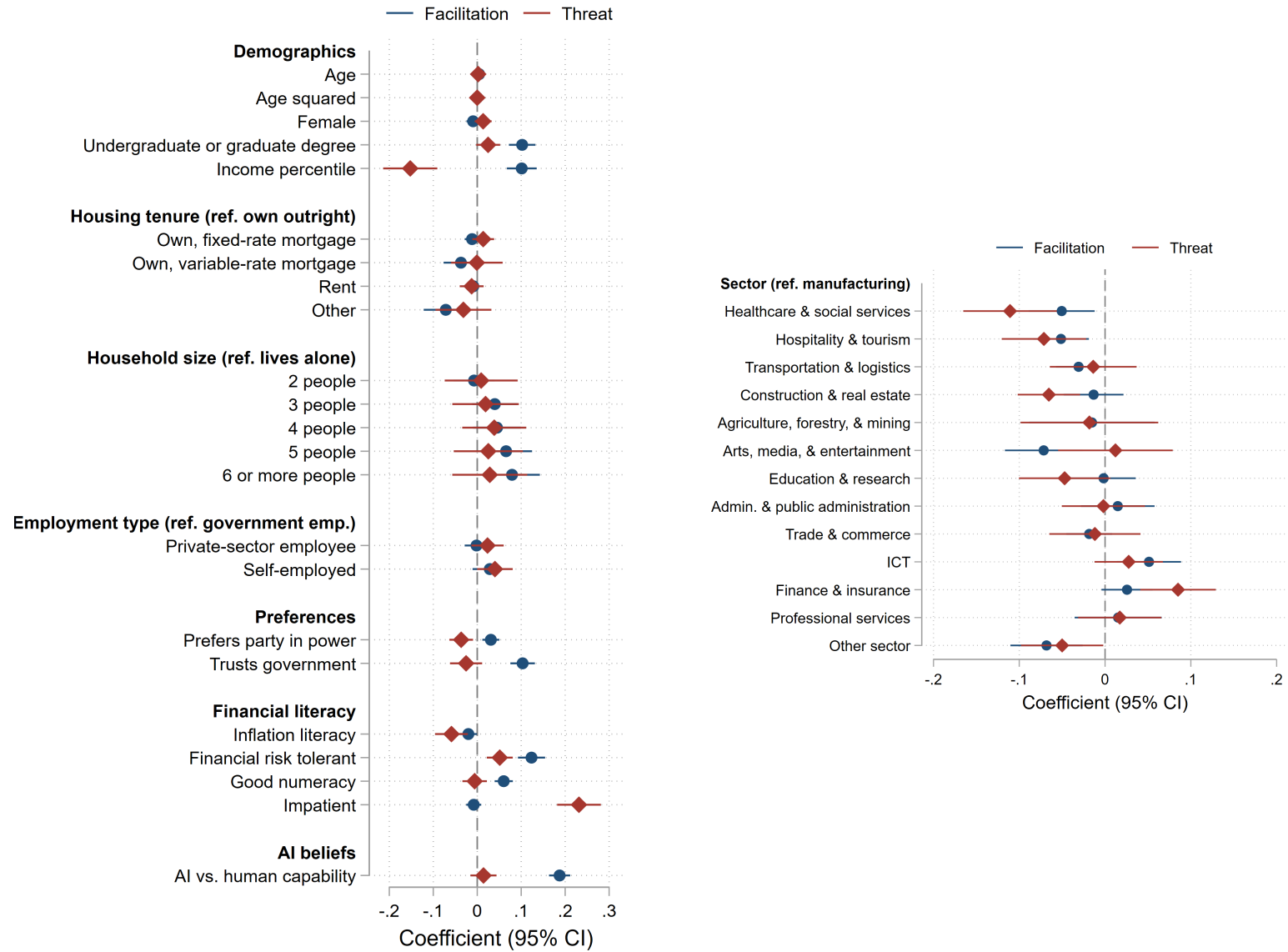


Figure 3: **Individual correlates of perceived AI facilitation and threat.** Coefficient estimates and 95% confidence intervals from regressions of perceived AI facilitation and perceived AI threat on respondents' demographic characteristics, economic preferences, financial literacy, AI beliefs, and sector of employment. All characteristics enter jointly, and all specifications include country fixed effects. Sector coefficients are relative to manufacturing.

Table 1: **Job-level AI beliefs and expected macroeconomic effects of AI.** Panel A reports coefficients from regressions of respondents' expected effects of AI on economic growth, employment, and inflation on perceived AI facilitation and threat, each coded from -1 to $+1$. Panel B replaces the continuous measures with mutually exclusive indicators for respondents who perceive facilitation only, threat only, or both; respondents reporting neither are the omitted category. All specifications include country fixed effects and controls for demographic characteristics, employment type and sector, economic preferences, financial literacy, and beliefs about AI's capabilities relative to human intelligence. Standard errors are clustered by country and reported in parentheses.

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	AI $\rightarrow$ Growth	AI $\rightarrow$ Employment	AI $\rightarrow$ Inflation
<i>Panel A. Own Job-level AI Expectations</i>			
Facilitation (-1 to $+1$)	0.153*** (0.007)	0.125*** (0.009)	-0.021** (0.008)
Threat (-1 to $+1$)	-0.034*** (0.009)	-0.087*** (0.017)	0.118*** (0.009)
<i>Panel B. Combined Job-level AI Expectations</i>			
Facilitation only	0.158*** (0.010)	0.104*** (0.012)	-0.057*** (0.008)
Threat only	-0.040*** (0.013)	-0.121*** (0.016)	0.092*** (0.009)
Facilitation & Threat	0.134*** (0.012)	0.073** (0.031)	0.153*** (0.016)
Observations	36,969	36,969	36,969
Country FE	Y	Y	Y
Demographic controls	Y	Y	Y
Preference controls	Y	Y	Y
Financial-literacy controls	Y	Y	Y

Standard errors clustered by country in parentheses. * $p < 0.10$, ** $p < 0.05$, *** $p < 0.01$.

Table 2: **Job-level AI beliefs and near-term economic outlooks.** The table reports coefficients from regressions of respondents' 12-month expectations for household income growth, unemployment, and inflation on perceived AI facilitation and threat, each coded from -1 to $+1$. These economic expectations were elicited before respondents encountered the AI module. Outcomes are winsorized and standardized within country. All specifications include country fixed effects and controls for demographic characteristics, employment type and sector, economic preferences, and financial literacy. Standard errors are clustered by country and reported in parentheses.

	(1) Household income	(2) Unemployment	(3) Inflation
AI facilitates work (-1 to $+1$)	0.062*** (0.014)	0.025 (0.016)	0.006 (0.016)
AI threatens work (-1 to $+1$)	-0.003 (0.017)	0.116*** (0.017)	0.087*** (0.016)
Observations	36,969	36,969	36,969
Country FE	Y	Y	Y
Demographic controls	Y	Y	Y
Preference controls	Y	Y	Y
Financial-literacy controls	Y	Y	Y
Adjusted R-squared	0.027	0.020	0.055

Standard errors in parentheses

Outcomes are winsorized and standardized within country.

* $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$

Supplementary Materials for “Will AI Help or Hurt Work and the Economy? What People Around the World Expect”

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A Data and Empirical Design

A.1 Survey and analysis sample

The survey was conducted in April and May 2026 across 32 countries and includes more than 64,000 adult respondents. Respondents were screened for age and attention (see detailed survey questions in Section E of the Supplementary Materials).

The survey was administered by Cint. Cint and its panel suppliers manage the legal consent. Respondents join via a “double opt-in” process, meaning they explicitly consent to join a market research panel, receive invitations, and have their data processed. Cint also ensures compliance with frameworks like GDPR and CCPA. Their platform ensures participants have the right to withdraw consent, view their data, or request data deletion through their dashboard at any time.

Cint recruited respondents from its global network of online survey panels and managed sampling separately within each country. We contracted with Cint to construct samples that matched the adult population along the joint distributions of age and gender, using country-specific population benchmarks and quota controls. During fieldwork, Cint targeted respondents based on their profiled demographic characteristics and closed demographic cells as their prespecified quotas were filled. Thus, the samples were designed to be representative of the adult population with respect to age and gender, rather than being probability samples of the full population.

Cint applies automated respondent-quality and fraud-detection procedures, including geographic verification, duplicate and suspicious-response detection, limits on excessive survey participation, and screening based on prior response-quality indicators.

Our dataset consists of de-identified survey data that was collected by a third-party survey company Cint and as such was determined as non-human-subject research.

Our analysis of job-level AI perceptions focuses on employed respondents. The survey asks respondents directly whether AI will facilitate or threaten their work and provides a separate response option for those who are not employed. In addition, employment status is elicited independently, distinguishing workers in the private sector, government, and self-employment from respondents who are not working, students, retirees, and unemployed respondents. The main job-level analysis is restricted to respondents employed in the private sector, government, or self-employment and excludes respondents selecting the “I am not employed” option in the AI job-impact question.

Our analysis sample is built in two steps. Of the 64,135 respondents to the survey, 63,196 responded to the question on employment status. Out of those, about 46,700 are employed (see Table S3). Non-missing responses on all control variables yields regression samples of roughly 35,000

to 37,000 observations, depending on the specification. Country-level TFP is not available for Vietnam, so respondents from that country drop out of the specifications that include TFP.

A.2 Measures of AI expectations

The survey elicits three sets of beliefs about AI. First, respondents are asked how they expect AI to compare with human intelligence ten years from now, using a five-point scale ranging from “well inferior” to “well superior”.

Second, respondents are asked separately how strongly they agree with the statements “AI will facilitate my work” and “AI will threaten my work.” Both questions use five-point agreement scales ranging from “not agree at all” to “fully agree”.

Third, respondents report how they expect AI to affect economic growth, employment, and inflation in their country. Each outcome is elicited on a five-point scale ranging from “decrease” to “increase,” with “no impact” as the midpoint. These questions do not specify a forecast horizon.

For these main AI variables, we recenter all of the five-point measures to range from -1 to $+1$, in increments of 0.5 , with zero corresponding to the scale midpoint.

For the joint-profile analysis, we define agreement as a response above the midpoint of the five-point agreement scale. Workers are classified into four mutually exclusive groups: facilitation only, threat only, both facilitation and threat, and neither. Midpoint responses are treated as non-agreement, so the “neither” category includes respondents who report neutral views on one or both dimensions.

A.3 Economic Expectations

We additionally examine respondents’ subjective 12-month-ahead expectations at the aggregate and personal household level for income growth, unemployment, and the most likely inflation rate. These questions are elicited separately from the AI module. The corresponding variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles within country and standardized within country before estimation.

A.4 Individual characteristics

The empirical specifications control for age, age squared, gender, education, within-country household-income percentile, employment status, and sector of work. The full set of controls additionally includes housing tenure, household size, financial literacy, financial risk tolerance, self-assessed mathematical ability, impatience, political alignment, trust in government, and beliefs about AI’s capabilities relative to human intelligence.

Household income is converted to a within-country percentile rank, allowing income position to be compared across countries with different currencies and income distributions.

For employed respondents, sector of work is classified into information and communication technology; finance and insurance; healthcare and social services; education, research, and scientific activities; manufacturing and industrial production; trade and commerce; hospitality, tourism, and food services; transportation and logistics; professional services; agriculture, forestry, mining, and

fishing; administrative activities and public administration; arts, entertainment, media, and sport; construction and real estate; and other sectors.

Table S1 describes the transformations applied to the few control variables that differ from their original survey coding.

Table S1: **Construction of binary control variables.** The table lists the transformation applied to survey responses. Question wording and response options are reported in Section E.

Variable	Transformation
Education	Equal to 1 for an undergraduate or graduate degree (categories 4–5), and 0 otherwise.
Trust in government	Equal to 1 for responses of 3 or 4, and 0 for 1 or 2.
Risk tolerance, numeracy, impatience	Equal to 1 if the statement describes the respondent somewhat or very well (3 or 4), and 0 otherwise. “Don’t know” is set to missing.
Inflation (financial) literacy	Equal to 1 for the correct answer, and 0 otherwise. “Don’t know/No opinion” is set to missing.
Prefers party in power	Equal to 1 if the preferred party is part of the government (“Yes”), and 0 for “No.” “Prefer not to answer” is set to missing.

A.5 Country-level data

Productivity. We merge the survey data with total factor productivity from the Penn World Table. Our measure is the level of TFP at current purchasing-power parities in 2023, normalized so that the United States equals one (see (25)).

Redundancy Rules. To examine whether perceived threat reflects labor-market institutions, we use the last World Bank’s Employing Workers data on redundancy rules from 2019 (26). We construct a country-level index as the sum of seven binary indicators, each equal to 1 if (i) the employer must notify or consult a third party before dismissing one redundant employee, (ii) the employer must obtain third-party approval to dismiss one redundant employee, (iii) the employer must notify or consult a third party before dismissing a group of nine redundant employees, (iv) the employer must obtain third-party approval to dismiss a group of nine, (v) the employer must retrain or reassign an employee before making the employee redundant, (vi) priority rules apply in case of redundancy dismissals or lay-offs, and (vii) priority rules apply to reemployment. The index ranges from 0 to 7, with higher values indicating stricter dismissal regulation.

A.6 Empirical specifications

For outcomes that vary at the individual level, we estimate regressions of the form

$$Y_{ic} = \beta X_{ic} + \Gamma Z_{ic} + \alpha_c + \varepsilon_{ic},$$

where Y_{ic} denotes the relevant AI belief of respondent i in country c , X_{ic} is the explanatory variable of interest, Z_{ic} contains the individual-level controls, and α_c denotes country fixed effects.

Standard errors are clustered at the country level.

Regressions involving country-level TFP omit country fixed effects because TFP varies only at the country level; standard errors are clustered by country in these specifications as well.

B Descriptive statistics

Table S2: **Summary statistics for the analysis sample.** The table reports summary statistics for the main variables used in the empirical analysis. Panels A–D use the sample of employed respondents in the private sector, government, or self-employment; N denotes the number of respondents with non-missing information for each variable. Panel A reports beliefs about AI, each coded from -1 to $+1$, with zero denoting the neutral midpoint. Panel B reports 12-month-ahead economic expectations; these variables are winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles within country. Panel C reports respondent characteristics, and Panel D reports binary indicators for demographic characteristics, economic preferences, and financial literacy. Panel E reports country-level total factor productivity at current purchasing-power parities in 2023, normalized to one for the United States; N denotes the number of countries.

	Mean	SD	N
Panel A. AI beliefs (-1 to $+1$)			
AI facilitates my work	0.40	0.57	46,700
AI threatens my work	-0.13	0.66	46,700
AI capability relative to humans	0.41	0.53	46,700
Expected AI effect on economic growth	0.30	0.45	46,700
Expected AI effect on employment	-0.10	0.57	46,700
Expected AI effect on inflation	0.15	0.43	46,700
Panel B. Conventional expectations, next 12 months			
Household income growth (%)	3.68	13.19	46,700
Unemployment rate (p.p. change)	3.53	13.43	46,700
Inflation rate (%)	12.98	19.01	46,700
Panel C. Respondent characteristics			
Age (years)	40.03	12.08	46,700
Panel D. Binary characteristics (share of respondents)			
Female	0.47	0.50	46,651
Undergraduate or graduate degree	0.67	0.47	46,700
Trusts the government	0.59	0.49	46,700
Prefers the party in power	0.57	0.49	41,812
Answers inflation question correctly	0.65	0.48	41,958
Financial risk tolerant	0.65	0.48	45,912
Good self-assessed numeracy	0.78	0.41	46,031
Impatient	0.44	0.50	45,996
Panel E. Country-level (N = number of countries)			
TFP, 2023 (US = 1)	0.74	0.20	31
WB redundancy rules index (0–7, higher = stricter)	2.06	2.09	32

Notes: For AI facilitation and threat, -1 denotes “not agree at all” and $+1$ “fully agree.” For AI capability relative to humans, -1 denotes “well inferior” and $+1$ “well superior.” For expected AI effects on growth, employment, and inflation, -1 denotes “strongly decrease” and $+1$ “strongly increase.” Household-income growth is the expected percentage change over the next 12 months; unemployment is the expected percentage-point change in the unemployment rate; inflation is the expected inflation rate. “Trusts the government” equals one for responses of 3 or 4 on the four-point trust scale. Financial risk tolerance, numeracy, and impatience equal one for responses of 3 or 4 on their respective five-point scales. Inflation literacy equals one if the respondent correctly recognizes that a 5% savings return does not preserve purchasing power regardless of inflation. Redundancy-rules index: sum of seven binary World Bank indicators of dismissal restrictions (third-party notification and approval for the dismissal of one and of nine workers; obligation to retrain or reassign; priority rules for redundancy; priority rules for reemployment), from 0 to 7 (higher values indicate stricter regulation).

Table S3: **Employment status in the full survey sample** The table reports the distribution of respondents across employment-status categories in the full survey sample. Entries are percentages of all respondents, including respondents who are not employed and therefore do not enter the main analysis of job-level AI beliefs. “Observations” denotes the number of respondents with non-missing employment-status information.

Employment status, full sample (%)	
Private sector	52.2
Government	8.5
Self-employed	13.4
Not working, not looking	3.6
Student	8.0
Retired	9.3
Unemployed, looking	5.0
Observations	63,196

Notes: Entries are percentages of all respondents. The main analysis of job-level AI beliefs is restricted to respondents employed in the private sector, government, or self-employment.

Table S4: **Background characteristics of the analysis sample.** The table reports the distribution of respondents across sectors of employment, housing-tenure categories, and household-size categories. All panels use the employed analysis sample consisting of respondents working in the private sector, government, or self-employment. Entries are percentages of respondents with non-missing information for the respective characteristic. “Observations” denotes the number of respondents with non-missing information in each panel.

Sector of employment	
ICT	14.5
Finance & insurance	9.0
Healthcare & social services	7.1
Education, research & science	6.9
Manufacturing & industrial	12.7
Trade & commerce	9.8
Hospitality, tourism & food	5.3
Transportation & logistics	5.8
Professional services	4.4
Agriculture, forestry, mining & fishing	2.3
Administration & public administration	3.4
Arts, entertainment, media & sport	2.9
Construction & real estate	5.6
Other	10.3
Observations	46,700

Housing tenure	
Own outright	52.2
Own – fixed mortgage	17.4
Own – variable mortgage	6.7
Rent	20.6
Other	3.1
Observations	46,401

Household size	
1 person (lives alone)	2.0
2 people	10.2
3 people	19.2
4 people	30.8
5 people	24.3
6 or more people	13.4
Observations	46,700

Notes: Entries are percentages of respondents in the employed analysis sample. “Observations” denotes the number of respondents with non-missing information for the respective variable.

C Survey and official benchmark statistics

This section compares the demographic composition of the survey samples with the country-specific population benchmarks used to construct the sampling quotas. For each country, Tables S5–S12 report the realized survey shares by gender and age alongside the corresponding benchmark shares. The tables also provide descriptive information on respondents’ education, household size, and gross household income to characterize the samples along dimensions that were not used to set the sampling quotas. The sources of the official benchmark statistics are reported separately for each country.

Table S5: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Argentina, Australia, Belgium, and Brazil.

	ARG		AUS		BEL		BRA	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	48.95	50.16	51.38	49.73	50.05	50.00	51.20	48.27
Female	51.05	49.84	48.62	50.27	49.95	50.00	48.80	51.73
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	26.81	27.60	23.28	24.35	30.43	21.60	24.59	25.95
Age (30–39)	23.86	22.38	25.42	21.96	23.89	19.62	25.74	22.37
Age (40–49)	21.47	20.49	19.58	19.17	19.09	19.29	21.15	21.00
Age (50–59)	17.62	15.92	14.49	17.43	12.64	19.30	19.65	17.08
Age (60–70)	10.23	13.61	17.23	17.09	13.94	20.19	8.88	13.59
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	67.10		37.41		41.48		45.04	
High (survey 4–5)	32.90		62.59		58.52		54.96	
Household size:								
Mean household size	4.10		4.00		3.97		4.02	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	14,757		73,524		143,371		53,908	
Median	4,115		69,589		82,621		16,839	
Standard deviation	22,997		47,523		190,226		210,919	
<i>N</i>	2,003		2,002		2,001		2,005	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Argentina: World Bank; Australia: Australian Bureau of Statistics; Belgium: Statbel; Brazil: Brazilian Census.

Table S6: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Canada, Switzerland, China, and Colombia.

	CAN		CHE		CHN		COL	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	51.20	50.48	49.98	50.46	51.35	51.21	50.25	49.30
Female	48.80	49.52	50.02	49.54	48.65	48.79	49.75	50.70
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	23.78	23.01	28.71	19.50	28.20	19.18	30.70	27.98
Age (30–39)	23.58	21.52	24.03	20.92	28.90	21.60	21.55	23.30
Age (40–49)	19.98	18.90	20.14	20.42	17.70	19.12	20.30	19.31
Age (50–59)	14.24	16.96	11.86	20.06	14.30	22.74	15.20	15.99
Age (60–70)	18.43	19.61	15.25	19.10	10.90	17.35	12.25	13.41
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	51.40		27.37		25.40		36.35	
High (survey 4–5)	48.60		72.63		74.60		63.65	
Household size:								
Mean household size	3.57		4.24		3.80		4.38	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	115,109		109,817		88,063		23,596	
Median	63,884		97,933		75,919		12,477	
Standard deviation	409,142		95,908		68,080		36,027	
<i>N</i>	2,002		2,006		2,000		2,000	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Canada: Statistics Canada; Switzerland: Federal Statistical Office; China and Colombia: World Bank.

Table S7: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Germany, Spain, France, and the United Kingdom.

	DEU		ESP		FRA		GBR	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	51.35	50.43	48.82	49.91	51.30	49.22	51.82	48.96
Female	48.65	49.57	51.18	50.09	48.70	50.78	48.18	51.04
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	22.69	19.35	25.40	18.86	24.64	22.66	23.49	22.34
Age (30–39)	22.44	19.08	23.60	17.30	20.54	17.88	25.04	20.50
Age (40–49)	19.64	18.59	19.05	22.25	20.14	18.90	19.66	19.03
Age (50–59)	16.59	20.07	18.55	22.20	16.04	19.97	13.14	20.56
Age (60–70)	18.64	22.91	13.40	19.39	18.64	20.58	18.67	17.57
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	65.67		55.10		50.02		35.74	
High (survey 4–5)	34.33		44.90		49.98		64.26	
Household size:								
Mean household size	3.41		3.87		3.32		3.95	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	71,210		52,314		56,299		90,414	
Median	62,327		46,980		46,584		76,692	
Standard deviation	51,083		42,410		56,837		62,957	
<i>N</i>	2,001		2,000		2,001		2,009	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Germany: Federal Statistical Office; Spain: National Statistics Institute; France: World Bank; United Kingdom: Office for National Statistics Census.

Table S8: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Hong Kong, Indonesia, India, and Italy.

	HKG		IDN		IND		ITA	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	45.83	43.77	51.32	50.32	51.15	51.04	49.60	50.01
Female	54.17	56.23	48.68	49.68	48.85	48.96	50.40	49.99
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	13.57	13.76	26.87	28.01	27.65	35.67	21.30	17.99
Age (30–39)	20.40	19.35	26.42	21.96	23.40	23.69	22.55	16.33
Age (40–49)	20.95	21.71	20.98	21.07	22.65	18.37	20.30	19.55
Age (50–59)	13.22	21.23	17.03	17.16	16.80	12.03	17.45	23.93
Age (60–70)	31.87	23.94	8.69	11.82	9.50	10.24	18.40	22.21
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	31.42		42.36		12.75		66.25	
High (survey 4–5)	68.58		57.64		87.25		33.75	
Household size:								
Mean household size	4.07		4.54		4.77		3.60	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	87,373		21,385		61,249		57,579	
Median	81,625		12,698		36,868		50,000	
Standard deviation	66,549		25,938		84,057		45,096	
<i>N</i>	2,005		2,002		2,000		2,000	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Hong Kong and Indonesia: World Bank; India: Census of India; Italy: National Institute of Statistics.

Table S9: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Japan, Korea, Mexico, and Malaysia.

	JPN		KOR		MEX		MYS	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	51.35	50.51	51.38	51.06	50.28	47.77	49.83	53.01
Female	48.65	49.49	48.62	48.94	49.72	52.23	50.17	46.99
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	19.39	18.64	22.15	18.30	28.90	30.12	28.94	30.67
Age (30–39)	22.19	16.12	24.15	17.93	25.35	23.06	24.18	23.83
Age (40–49)	20.94	20.26	19.40	19.94	21.65	19.33	20.66	20.46
Age (50–59)	18.24	23.72	16.10	22.30	17.25	15.95	11.35	13.87
Age (60–70)	19.24	21.26	18.20	21.53	6.85	11.54	14.87	11.17
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	44.48		28.55		53.75		32.76	
High (survey 4–5)	55.52		71.45		46.25		67.24	
Household size:								
Mean household size	3.09		3.61		4.54		4.51	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	50,619		69,155		22,045		56,240	
Median	42,870		63,518		14,276		50,738	
Standard deviation	49,436		54,533		26,824		55,820	
<i>N</i>	2,001		2,000		2,000		2,018	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Japan, Korea, and Mexico: World Bank; Malaysia: Department of Statistics.

Table S10: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Netherlands, Philippines, Poland, and Russia.

	NLD		PHL		POL		RUS	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	51.17	50.19	49.21	49.80	49.77	49.48	51.83	47.28
Female	48.83	49.81	50.79	50.20	50.23	50.52	48.17	52.72
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	22.18	22.80	28.82	34.27	30.22	17.30	23.30	17.84
Age (30–39)	26.12	19.40	27.43	24.04	22.58	20.35	23.85	21.72
Age (40–49)	21.04	17.43	21.26	18.34	22.98	23.97	20.60	22.42
Age (50–59)	14.06	20.11	16.21	13.64	14.19	18.42	16.40	17.99
Age (60–70)	16.60	20.25	6.28	9.71	10.04	19.96	15.85	20.03
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	32.30		24.32		57.24		34.40	
High (survey 4–5)	67.70		75.68		42.76		65.60	
Household size:								
Mean household size	3.79		4.74		3.67		4.10	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	107,754		20,937		51,397		44,093	
Median	77,720		13,009		41,819		27,043	
Standard deviation	83,220		22,043		51,425		69,130	
<i>N</i>	2,006		2,023		2,002		2,000	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Netherlands: Statistics Netherlands; Philippines and Russia: World Bank; Poland: Statistics Poland.

Table S11: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Sweden, and Thailand.

	SAU		SGP		SWE		THA	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	49.70	64.33	50.50	48.70	51.10	50.94	48.66	48.84
Female	50.30	35.67	49.50	51.30	48.90	49.06	51.34	51.16
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	31.30	29.30	27.80	18.70	23.60	21.38	29.28	21.82
Age (30–39)	31.60	32.10	25.60	21.11	21.96	21.92	26.00	19.36
Age (40–49)	19.66	21.90	21.95	20.25	20.16	18.89	25.16	20.20
Age (50–59)	11.19	11.30	17.40	19.75	16.47	19.49	13.75	20.47
Age (60–70)	6.24	5.40	7.25	20.19	17.81	18.32	5.81	18.15
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	25.80		24.05		57.29		29.98	
High (survey 4–5)	74.20		75.95		42.71		70.02	
Household size:								
Mean household size	4.97		4.11		3.52		4.17	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	105,351		136,302		56,682		53,321	
Median	72,262		114,504		54,486		39,414	
Standard deviation	143,316		121,198		37,132		56,560	
<i>N</i>	2,019		2,000		2,004		2,015	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Saudi Arabia and Thailand: World Bank; Singapore: SingStat; Sweden: Statistics Sweden.

Table S12: Survey sample and population benchmarks: Turkey, United States, Viet Nam, and South Africa.

	TUR		USA		VNM		ZAF	
	Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota		Survey Quota	
Gender (%):								
Male	50.47	50.24	51.17	49.91	48.37	48.93	49.95	48.63
Female	49.53	49.76	48.83	50.09	51.63	51.07	50.05	51.37
Age groups (%):								
Age (18–29)	30.24	26.22	24.53	23.52	34.40	23.26	31.63	30.19
Age (30–39)	25.41	21.76	23.08	20.61	28.90	24.38	21.49	26.33
Age (40–49)	21.82	21.74	18.48	18.65	21.80	21.47	20.64	20.27
Age (50–59)	14.35	16.72	15.73	17.85	10.25	17.03	15.64	13.13
Age (60–70)	8.17	13.56	18.18	19.36	4.65	13.86	10.59	10.08
Education (%):								
Low + middle (survey 1–3)	44.00		46.60		23.95		56.07	
High (survey 4–5)	56.00		53.40		76.05		43.93	
Household size:								
Mean household size	4.07		3.70		4.48		4.44	
Gross income (USD PPP):								
Mean	32,519		70,443		43,830		37,723	
Median	24,748		65,000		41,671		20,040	
Standard deviation	36,399		49,607		44,850		52,743	
<i>N</i>	2,007		2,002		2,000		2,001	

Notes: The table compares the realized survey composition with the population benchmarks used to construct the age and gender sampling quotas. Survey statistics are unweighted. Age and gender benchmarks refer to the population aged 18–70. Education, household size, and gross household income are descriptive characteristics of the realized survey sample and were not used to construct the sampling quotas. Gross household income is expressed in U.S. dollars at purchasing-power parity and winsorized at the 1st and 99th percentiles. Household size is top-coded at six or more persons; its reported mean should therefore be interpreted as a lower bound. *N* denotes the number of survey respondents.

Sources: Turkey, Viet Nam, and South Africa: World Bank; United States: Census Bureau.

D Additional Results and Robustness

This section reports additional analyses that complement the main results and assess their robustness. We examine alternative representations of the joint distribution of perceived AI facilitation and threat, additional cross-country relationships, and robustness of the main productivity and employment-protection results.

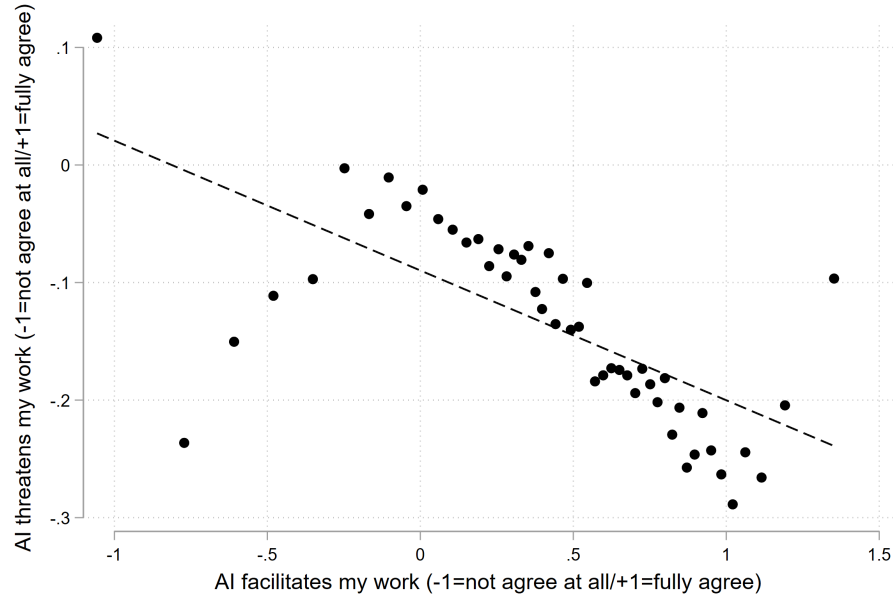


Figure S1: **Within-country relationship between perceived AI facilitation and threat.** Conditional binscatter of perceived threat against perceived facilitation among employed respondents. Both measures range from -1 to $+1$. Country fixed effects and individual characteristics are partialled out before constructing the bins. The fitted relationship is negative on average but non-linear, with a locally positive association among respondents reporting low levels of both facilitation and threat.

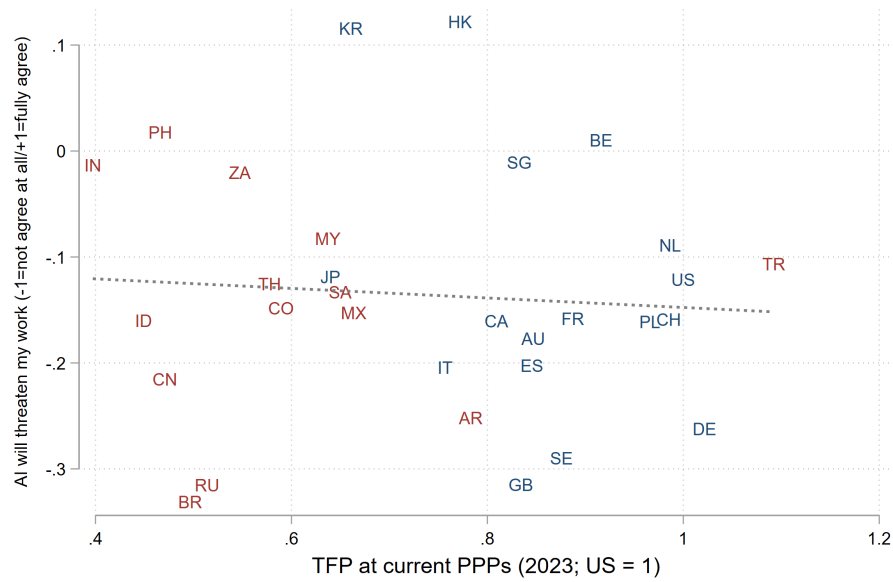


Figure S2: **Perceived AI threat is unrelated to country-level productivity.** Country-level mean perceived threat is plotted against total factor productivity in 2023 at current purchasing-power parities, normalized to one for the United States. Each marker represents one country. Advanced economies are shown in blue and emerging-market economies in red. The fitted line summarizes the cross-country relationship. Vietnam is excluded because comparable TFP data are unavailable.

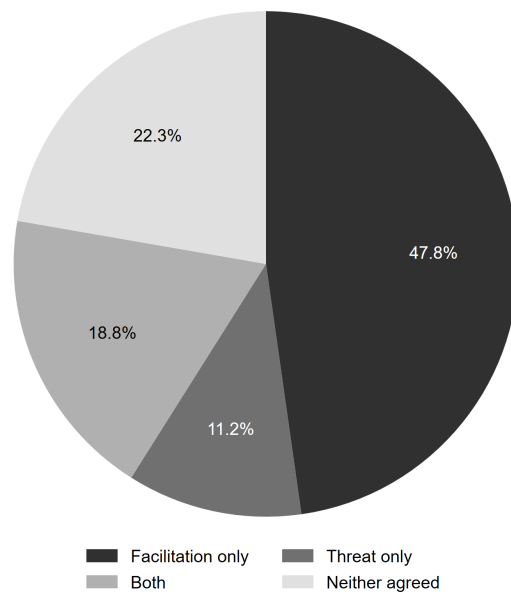
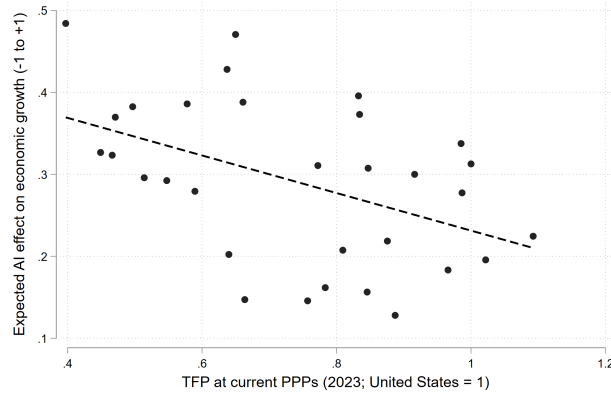
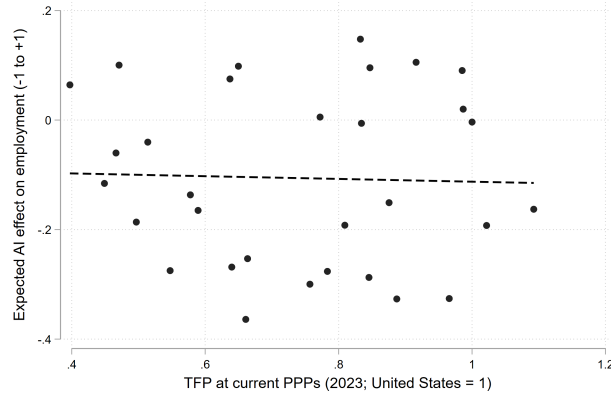


Figure S3: **Joint profiles of perceived AI facilitation and threat.** Shares of employed respondents who agree that AI will facilitate their work, threaten their work, both, or neither. Agreement is defined as selecting one of the two responses above the midpoint of the five-point agreement scale.

Panel A. Expected AI effects on growth decline in TFP



Panel B. Expected AI effects on employment unrelated to TFP



Panel C. Expected AI effects on inflation unrelated to TFP

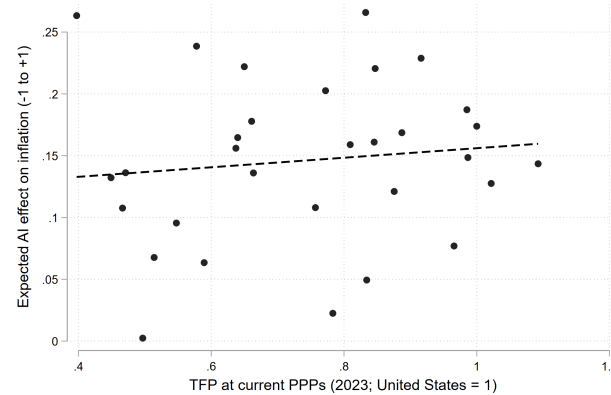


Figure S4: Expected AI effects on growth, employment, and inflation and country-level productivity. Country-level relationship between expected AI effects on economic growth (Panel A), employment (Panel B), and inflation (Panel C) and total factor productivity at current purchasing-power parities, normalized to one for the United States.

Table S13: **Productivity frontier and perceived job effects: robustness.** The table reports coefficients from regressions of perceived AI facilitation and threat, each coded from -1 to $+1$, on country-level total factor productivity (TFP) in 2023 at current purchasing-power parities, normalized to one for the United States. All specifications include controls for demographic characteristics, employment type and sector, economic preferences, and financial literacy. Country fixed effects are omitted because TFP varies only across countries. Standard errors are clustered by country and reported in parentheses.

	(1) Facilitation	(2) Threat
TFP at current PPPs (2023, US = 1)	-0.320*** (0.098)	-0.052 (0.083)
Observations	35,464	35,464
Country FE	N	N
Demographic controls	Y	Y
Preference controls	Y	Y
Financial-literacy controls	Y	Y
Adjusted R-squared	0.147	0.054

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$

Table S14: **Employment protection and perceived job effects of AI** The table reports coefficients from regressions of perceived AI facilitation and threat, each coded from -1 to $+1$, on the World Bank Redundancy Rules Index, which captures regulatory and institutional constraints on layoffs. All specifications include controls for demographic characteristics, employment type and sector, economic preferences, and financial literacy. Country fixed effects are omitted because the Redundancy Rules Index varies only across countries. Standard errors are clustered by country and reported in parentheses.

	(1) Facilitation	(2) Threat
Redundancy-rules index	-0.002 (0.010)	0.002 (0.007)
Observations	36,969	36,969
Country FE	N	N
Demographic controls	Y	Y
Preference controls	Y	Y
Financial-literacy controls	Y	Y
Adjusted R-squared	0.138	0.057

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$

Table S15: **Individual correlates of perceived AI facilitation and threat** The table reports coefficients from regressions of perceived AI facilitation and perceived AI threat, each coded from -1 to $+1$, on respondents' demographic characteristics, employment type and sector, economic preferences, financial literacy, and beliefs about AI's capabilities relative to human intelligence. All covariates enter jointly, and all specifications include country fixed effects. Housing-tenure coefficients are relative to respondents who own their home outright, household-size coefficients are relative to respondents living alone, employment-type coefficients are relative to government employees, and sector coefficients are relative to manufacturing. Standard errors are clustered by country and reported in parentheses.

	(1) Facilitation	(2) Threat
Demographics		
Age	0.004* (0.002)	0.002 (0.003)
Age squared	-0.000** (0.000)	-0.000 (0.000)
Female	-0.009 (0.008)	0.013 (0.009)
Undergraduate or graduate degree	0.102*** (0.015)	0.025* (0.013)
Income percentile	0.101*** (0.017)	-0.152*** (0.030)
Housing tenure (ref. own outright)		
Own, fixed-rate mortgage	-0.012 (0.008)	0.014 (0.012)
Own, variable-rate mortgage	-0.037* (0.019)	-0.001 (0.029)
Rent	-0.009 (0.011)	-0.013 (0.013)
Other	-0.072*** (0.025)	-0.031 (0.031)
Household size (ref. lives alone)		
2 people	-0.007 (0.023)	0.009 (0.041)
3 people	0.040 (0.025)	0.019 (0.037)
4 people	0.045 (0.027)	0.039 (0.036)
5 people	0.066** (0.029)	0.025 (0.039)
6 or more people	0.079** (0.031)	0.029 (0.042)
Employment type (ref. government employee)		
Private-sector employee	-0.002 (0.013)	0.023 (0.018)
Self-employed	0.029 (0.019)	0.040* (0.020)

Table S15: **Individual correlates of perceived AI facilitation and threat** (continued)

	(1) Facilitation	(2) Threat
Sector (ref. manufacturing)		
Healthcare & social services	-0.051** (0.019)	-0.111*** (0.027)
Hospitality & tourism	-0.051*** (0.016)	-0.071*** (0.024)
Transportation & logistics	-0.031** (0.013)	-0.014 (0.025)
Construction & real estate	-0.013 (0.017)	-0.065*** (0.018)
Agriculture, forestry, & mining	-0.015 (0.036)	-0.018 (0.039)
Arts, media, & entertainment	-0.072*** (0.022)	0.012 (0.033)
Education & research	-0.002 (0.018)	-0.047* (0.026)
Admin. & public administration	0.015 (0.021)	-0.002 (0.024)
Trade & commerce	-0.018 (0.013)	-0.012 (0.026)
ICT	0.051*** (0.018)	0.028 (0.020)
Finance & insurance	0.026* (0.015)	0.085*** (0.022)
Professional services	0.015 (0.025)	0.017 (0.024)
Other sector	-0.068*** (0.021)	-0.050** (0.024)
Preferences		
Prefers party in power	0.031*** (0.009)	-0.036*** (0.013)
Trusts government	0.103*** (0.014)	-0.025 (0.018)
Financial literacy		
Inflation literacy	-0.020** (0.010)	-0.059*** (0.018)
Financial risk tolerant	0.123*** (0.015)	0.051*** (0.014)
Good numeracy	0.060*** (0.010)	-0.006 (0.014)
Impatient	-0.008 (0.008)	0.231*** (0.024)
AI beliefs		
AI vs. human capability	0.187*** (0.012)	0.014 (0.015)
Observations	36,969	36,969
Country FE	Y	Y
Adjusted R-squared	0.178	0.079

Standard errors in parentheses

* $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$

E Survey Questions

Below we reproduce the original survey questions and response options in English. Question wording and ordering follow the questionnaire administered to respondents; country-specific versions were translated into the relevant official languages using the common translation protocol described in Section A.

At the beginning of the survey, each respondent read the following introduction text:

Thank you very much for participating in this survey, which is expected to take about 8-10 minutes. This survey is designed to gather your views on economic issues. We are interested in your opinion, so there is no right or wrong answer. Even if you are unsure, please answer to the best of your knowledge. We would be grateful if you could complete the survey in a single session without distractions. We highly value your time and attention.

Question 1 *What is your age?*

[Integers from 0 to unbounded]

...

Question 2 *What is your gender?*

1. Male
2. Female
3. Prefer not to answer

Question 3 *In questionnaires like ours, sometimes there are participants who do not carefully read the questions and just quickly click through the survey. This means that there are many random answers which compromise the results of research studies. To show that you read our questions carefully, please choose that you are “**very interested**” in **sports** and “**not interested at all**” in **music**.*

- How interested are you in sports?
 - How interested are you in music?
1. Not interested at all
 2. Not interested
 3. Interested
 4. Very interested

We would like to ask you about the rate of inflation in your country. As you may know, inflation is the percentage change in overall prices in the economy. For example, if a price increases from 10 to 11, the rate of inflation is $(11 - 10)/10 = 10\%$. If a price decreases from 10 to 9, the rate of inflation is $(9 - 10)/10 = -10\%$. If a price does not change, the rate of inflation is 0%.

Question 4 *Over the **last** 12 months, what do you believe the rate of inflation has been in your country?*

...%

Question 5 *Now think about the possible rate of inflation in your country over the **next 12 months**. What do you expect could be the lowest, highest, and most likely value of inflation?*

- Lowest ...%
- Highest ...%
- Most likely ...%

Question 6 *Thinking about your previous responses about the rate of inflation, were there any specific prices of goods that you had in mind when responding? Please select all that apply.*

[randomized; select all that apply]

1. Food / groceries
2. Rent
3. Gasoline / other energy prices
4. Clothing
5. Electronics / appliances
6. Education
7. Other
8. No specific prices

Question 7 *Over the **next 12 months**, do you expect your **household income** to increase, decrease, or stay about the same?*

1. Increase by about ...%
2. Decrease by about ...%

3. Stay about the same as today

Question 8 *Over the **next 12 months**, do you expect the **unemployment rate** in your country to increase, decrease, or stay about the same relative to the current level?*

1. Increase by ... percentage points
2. Decrease by ... percentage points
3. Stay about the same as today

Question 9 *Over the **next 12 months**, do you expect **interest rates** in your country to increase, decrease, or stay about the same relative to current levels?*

1. Increase by ... percentage points
2. Decrease by ... percentage points
3. Stay about the same as today

Question 10 *How much trust do you have in each of the following institutions to act in your best interest?*

[randomized]

- Your country's central bank / The central bank of the Euro Area
- Your country's government
- Your country's banks and financial institutions

1. Not at all
2. Not too much
3. Some
4. A lot

Question 11 *We would like to seek your views on Artificial Intelligence (AI). How do you think that AI will compare to human intelligence in 10 years from now?*

[5 point slider]

1. well inferior
2. somewhat inferior
3. similar

4. somewhat superior
5. well superior

Question 12 *We would like to understand how you think AI will impact **your job**. To what extent do you agree with the following statements?*

- AI will facilitate my work
- AI will threaten my work
- I am not employed

[5 point slide except "I am not employed"]

1. not agree at all
2. somewhat disagree
3. neither agree nor disagree
4. somewhat agree
5. fully agree

Question 13 *Now we would like to understand your perceptions of how AI can impact the **broadier economy** in your country. How do you think AI will impact the following?*

- Economic growth
- Employment
- Inflation

[5 point slide]

1. Strongly decrease
2. Decrease
3. No impact
4. Increase
5. Strongly increase

Question 14 *In your opinion, is this statement true or false:*

If the money in your savings account grows at an annual rate of 5%, then you will be able to buy more with this money in the future than you are able to buy today regardless of the rate of inflation.

1. True
2. False
3. Don't know/No opinion

Question 15 *How often do you do the following activities in **a typical month**?*

[Integer from 0 to 100]

- Shop for groceries: ...
- Buy gasoline: ...

Question 16 *How well, if at all, do the following sentences describe you as a person?*

[randomized]

- I am willing to take risks regarding financial matters
- I am good at math
- I am very impatient

1. Not at all well
2. Not too well
3. Somewhat well
4. Very well
5. Don't know/No opinion

Question 17 *What is your household annual income before taxes?*

[Integers from 0 to unbounded]

... ["name of local currency"]

Question 18 *Which of the following best characterizes your household?*

1. Own my house/apartment without a mortgage/loan
2. Own my house/apartment and have a fixed-rate mortgage/loan
3. Own my house/apartment and have a variable-rate mortgage/loan
4. Rent my house/apartment
5. Other

6. Don't know/Prefer not to answer

Question 19 *How would you describe your present employment situation?*

1. Job in the private sector
2. Job in government
3. Self-employed
4. Not working and not looking for work
5. Student
6. Retired
7. Unemployed, looking for work
8. Prefer not to answer

[Only if 1, 2, or 3]

Question 19a *Which sector do you work in?*

1. Information & Communication Technology
2. Finance & Insurance
3. Healthcare & Social Services
4. Education, Research and Scientific Activities
5. Manufacturing & Industrial Production
6. Trade & Commerce
7. Hospitality, Tourism & Food Services
8. Transportation & Logistics
9. Professional Services in Law, Consulting, Architecture, Design
10. Agriculture, Forestry, Mining, Fishing
11. Administrative Activities, Public Administration & Defense
12. Arts, Entertainment, Media, Sport
13. Construction & Real Estate Activities
14. Other. please specify: _____

Question 19b *Please specify your current job position: _____*

Question 20 *Please tell us how many people usually live in your primary residence other than yourself (including those who are temporarily away).*

1. 1 person
2. 2 people
3. 3 people
4. 4 people
5. 5 or more people
6. None

Question 21 *What is the highest level of education you have achieved?*

1. Less than high school
2. High school
3. Some college but no degree (including academic, vocational, or occupational programs)
4. Undergraduate degree (for example: BA, BS)
5. Graduate or post-graduate degree (for example: MA, MS, PhD, MD, JD)

[If answered 4 or 5]

Question 21a *Do you have any degrees in business, finance, or economics?*

1. Yes
2. No

Question 22 *Is the party that best aligns with your political views currently part of the government in your home country?*

1. Yes
2. No
3. Prefer not to answer